

KATE ERICKSON

Technical Writer | UX Writer | Documentation Strategist

Portfolio: k8erickson.github.io/Writing-Portfolio

Experienced documentation leader with a graduate degree in English and 10+ years of experience transforming messy complexity into lean, usable documentation. Skilled in producing a full range of content, including user guides, API references, release notes, troubleshooting articles, UX copy, style guides, and more. Proven expertise in structured authoring, content reuse, and docs-as-code methods, while leveraging AI tools to improve productivity. Highly collaborative and comfortable working in fast-paced, iterative environments. Passionate about improving systems for everyone.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Version control:** Docs-as-code methods with GitHub/Bitbucket (branch management, PR reviews), CLI tools
 - **Writing & strategy:** Style guides, information architecture, modular writing, SEO, localization readiness, accessibility (508)
 - **UX writing:** UI copy guidelines, product voice & tone, error messages, consistent patterns
 - **Tools:** MadCap Flare, Author-it, Adobe FrameMaker, Snagit, Confluence, Jira, Salesforce, DITA/XML, HTML/CSS, Markdown
 - **Agile & cross-functional collaboration:** SAFe® Agile Certified, backlog refinement, sprint planning
 - **AI & productivity:** AI prompting, AI-assisted coding (VS Code & GitHub Copilot)
 - **Platforms:** Windows, macOS, Ubuntu/Linux
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WORK EXPERIENCE

ASRC Federal – USDA-NRCS Contract (Remote), Jan 2022 – July 2025

Principal Technical Writer, Tech Docs Team Lead, UX Writing Lead

- Led the documentation and UX writing efforts for a SaaS conservation planning platform used nationwide, partnering with developers, UX designers, and business stakeholders.
- Wrote end-user help content and UI copy for GIS and conservation planning tools for agriculture and land management.
- Guided decisions about the redesign of the public-facing NRCS Registry application by advocating for consistent, clear terminology in the UI, help content, and customer communications.
- Set up and managed the infrastructure for a docs-as-code, Git-based documentation system integrated with MadCap Flare, enabling structured authoring and context-sensitive help.
- Wrote and maintained an internal authoring guide covering style, best practices, SOPs, and troubleshooting.

- Mentored writers on lean writing and docs-as-code practices; led regular peer reviews to promote consistency and continuous improvement.
- Wrote UX content guidelines and improved product usability through consistent microcopy and error messaging.

CA Technologies (Fort Collins, CO), Aug 2011 – Sept 2016

Principal Technical Writer, Information Architect

- Led content development for multiple enterprise IT management products, collaborating with Agile teams, planning localization, and publishing release content.
- Created and maintained user and developer documentation, including release notes, user guides, API references, and integration guides; wrote UX content for a freemium SaaS product.
- Planned the information architecture and led the migration to a Confluence-based documentation system that improved scalability and searchability.
- Managed interactions with the user community, analyzed community feedback, and refined documentation to improve customer satisfaction.
- Mentored new hires on best practices, how to use the products, and authoring tools.

Natek – USDA-ITS Contract (Fort Collins, CO), Sept 2008 – July 2011

Senior Technical Writer

- Developed standard operating procedures and best practice guides for USDA web-hosting staff, including system administrators, database administrators, and monitoring engineers.
- Built and championed an internal wiki that improved collaboration and knowledge sharing.

Hewlett-Packard (Fort Collins, CO), June 2006 – Sept 2008

Senior Technical Writer, Project Lead

- Developed content for HP's Mid-Range servers, including installation posters and user guides.
- Led the planning and delivery of server configuration tools and enterprise storage software.

EDUCATION

M.A., English – Colorado State University, 2008

B.A., Spanish Language and Literature, *cum laude* – Fort Lewis College, 2000

KEY PROJECTS & IMPACT

- **Documentation system improvements:** Rescued and led the migration to a Git-based docs-as-code system integrated with MadCap Flare, enabling efficient multi-author

collaboration. Created and maintained a collection of reusable content snippets that improved efficiency and led the effort to implement context-sensitive help.

- **UX writing initiative:** Led NRCS's first microcopy project, developed guidelines for voice, tone, and UI elements, and worked alongside UX to improve frustrating areas of the UI with consistent copy and clear messaging.
- **Tech Docs authoring guide:** Created an internal team resource covering style, writing standards, source control procedures, and troubleshooting.
- **Community of practice:** Spearheaded a CoP for NRCS technical writing teams that leveraged the authoring guide I created to raise documentation quality and consistency across teams.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- MadCap Flare Advanced Training – Sept 2023
- SAFe® 5 Practitioner Certification – Feb 2022

LANGUAGES

Spanish (fluent) · French (basic proficiency)